

HERING'S LAW - DIRECTION OF CURE IN HOMEOPATHY

Nino Qurashvili

PhD, Professor, University of Georgia,
School of Health Sciences, Department of Pharmacy

RESUME

Homeopathy, founded by **Dr. Samuel Hahnemann**, is an alternative system of therapeutics based on the **Law of Similars** — *similia similibus curentur* — which asserts that substances capable of producing specific symptoms in healthy individuals can, in appropriate dilution, cure similar symptoms in the diseased. The system is further supported by **Hering's Law of Direction of Cure**, articulated by **Dr. Constantine Hering**, which describes the characteristic patterns observed during true healing under homeopathic treatment. Hering's Law outlines that genuine recovery progresses: **From within outward; From above downward; From more important organs to less important ones; and In the reverse order of symptom appearance.**

These principles integrate a **hierarchical understanding of the human organism**, encompassing three interdependent planes of function — **mental/spiritual, emotional, and physical** — and a further hierarchy within physical systems based on **functional centrality and impact**. The mental plane is regarded as the highest and most central domain, governing consciousness, cognition, and individuality; the emotional plane functions as a mediator of affective balance and adaptive behavior; and the physical plane, while biologically indispensable, is viewed as peripheral in relation to the higher planes.

Understanding these hierarchies allows practitioners to interpret the **direction of symptom change** as either favorable or adverse. Healing that moves from higher to lower levels — e.g., from mental and emotional toward physical expression — or from vital to less vital organs, signifies **curative progression**. Conversely, a reversal of this order indicates **pathological deterioration**.

From a physiological standpoint, the human body also exhibits an internal hierarchy of organ systems. Systems such as the **nervous, circulatory, endocrine, and digestive** occupy the highest ranks due to their vital, non-redundant functions, whereas systems such as the **respiratory, excretory, reproductive, skeletal, and muscular** possess varying degrees of redundancy and resilience. Recognition of this gradation supports a deeper understanding of disease evolution and the assessment of therapeutic outcomes.

Key Words: Homeopathy, Hering's Law, Direction of Cure, physical plane, emotional plane, mental plane.

განკურნების მიმართულება ჰომეოპათიაში - ჰერინგის კანონი

ნინო ყურაშვილი

PhD, პროფესორი, საქართველოს
უნივერსიტეტი, ჯანმრთელობის
მეცნიერებების სკოლა,
ფარმაციის დეპარტამენტი

ჰომეოპათია წარმოადგენს სამედიცინო ჰანემანის მიერ ჩამოყალიბებულ ალტერნატიულ თერაპიულ სისტემას, რომელიც ეფუძნება „მსგავსის მსგავსით მკურნალობის“ პრინციპს (*similia similibus curentur*) და რომლის მიხედვითაც ნივთიერებებს, რომლებიც ინვევენ კონკრეტულ სიმპტომებს ჯანმრთელ ორგანიზმში, შესაბამისი განზავებით შუძლიათ მსგავსი სიმპტომების განკურნება დაავადებულ ადამიანში.

აღნიშნულ სისტემას ეყრდნობა დოქტორ **ჰერინგის მკურნალობის მიმართულების კანონი**. კანონი აღწერს განკურნების მიმართულებებს, რომლებიც აღინიშნება რეალური გამოჯანმრთელების პროცესში ჰომეოპათიური მკურნალობის დროს. ეს მიმართულებებია:

- შიგნიდან გარეთ
- ზემოდან ქვემოთ
- მნიშვნელოვანი ორგანოებიდან ნაკლებად მნიშვნელოვან ორგანოებამდე
- სიმპტომების წარმოშობის თანმიმდევრობის საპირისპიროდ

აღნიშნული პრინციპები ადამიანის ორგანიზმის ფუნქციური იერარქიის ინტეგრირებული გააზრების საშუალებას გვაძლევს, რომელიც მოიცავს სამი ურთიერთდაკავშირებული სიბრტყის შეფასებას: **მენტალურ-სულიერის, ემოციურის და ფიზიკურის.**

- **მენტალურ-სულიერი სიბრტყე:** უმაღლესი და ცენტრალური დონის ფუნქციების მართვა, ცნობიერების, კოგნიტური უნარების და ინდივიდუალობის რეგულირება.
- **ემოციური სიბრტყე:** ემოციური ბალანსის, ადაპტაციური ქცევის და ფსიქოლოგიური რეგულაციის მედიატორი.
- **ფიზიკური სიბრტყე:** ბიოლოგიურად აუცილებელი, თუმცა, უმაღლეს სიბრტყეებთან შედარებით, იერარქიულად პერიფერიულია.

სიმპტომების ცვლილების მიმართულება (მაღა-

ლიდან დაბალ სიბრტყეებზე, მნიშვნელოვანი ორგანოებიდან ნაკლებად მნიშვნელოვნამდე) ასახავს მკურნალობის პროგრესს; საპირისპირო მიმართულება მიუთითებს პათოლოგიურ დეგრადაციაზე.

ფიზიოლოგიური თვალსაზრისით, ორგანიზმი ავლენს **შინაგან იერარქიას ორგანოთა სისტემებს შორის**.

- უმაღლეს რანგში არიან ნერვული, სისხლის მიმოქცევის, ენდოკრინული და საჭმლის მომნელებელი სისტემები მათი სიცოცხლისთვის მნიშვნელოვანი, უნიკალური ფუნქციების გამო.

- საშუალო და დაბალ რანგში განთავსებულია სასუნთქი, ექსკრეტორული, რეპროდუქციული და ძვალკუნთოვანი სისტემები, რომლებსაც სხვადასხვა დონეზე აქვთ ფუნდამენტური მნიშვნელობა.

არსებული იერარქიული სტრუქტურის აღიარება ხელს უწყობს დაავადების პროგრესის უკეთ გააზრებას და თერაპიული შედეგების ობიექტურ შეფასებას.

საკვანძო სიტყვები: ჰომეოპათია, ჰერინგი, ჰერინგის კანონი, განკურნების მიმართულება ჰომეოპათიაში, ფიზიკური სიბრტყე, ემოციური სიბრტყე, მენტალური სიბრტყე.

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Homeopathy is the alternative therapeutic system developed by the German Physician Samuel Hahnemann (Meissen, Germany 1755 / Paris 1843). The name derives from the Greek words homoios = 'similar' + pathos = 'suffering' or 'disease'. (1) This name reflects the **core principle of homeopathy**, known as the **Law of Similars**, which says: *A substance that causes symptoms in a healthy person can be used to treat similar symptoms in a sick person.* For example: Onion (*Allium cepa*) causes watery eyes and a runny nose in healthy people. Therefore, in homeopathy, a diluted form of *Allium cepa* can be used to treat a cold or hay fever with similar symptoms.

Homeopathy treats the patient with remedies that produce similar symptoms in healthy individuals (5), (6), (7) and

is governed by two laws:

1. **The Law of Similars:** The fundamental law of selection of the similar dynamic force which demands a total understanding of the concept of the Hahnemannian totality, the ability to perceive it in the area of disease (drug as well as natural) and the capacity to achieve its establishment on the similar plane through the adoption of suitable techniques and the application of the right clinical judgment.

2. **The Law of Direction of Cure (Hering):** The law of verification that gives us the requisite feedback in respect of the accuracy we have achieved in respect of

the correct application of the Law of Similars. And we must ever remember that Law does not recognize exceptions." (3).

This article aims to elucidate and synthesize the fundamental principles underlying Dr. Constantine Hering's Law of Direction of Cure.

Hering's Law of Cure describes the natural direction of healing under the influence of a correctly chosen homeopathic remedy. It states that when true healing occurs, it proceeds according to specific observable patterns.

Dr. Constantine Hering (1800–1880) was one of the most important figures in the history of homeopathy and is often called the "Father of American Homeopathy." He was born in Oschatz, Saxony (Germany) in 1800, studied medicine at the University of Leipzig. In 1833, Hering emigrated to the United States, where he became the leading advocate and teacher of homeopathy. He helped establish several homeopathic institutions, including: The Homeopathic Medical College of Pennsylvania (now part of Drexel University College of Medicine) and The Hahnemann Medical College in Philadelphia.

Initially, he was a skeptic and critic of homeopathy, having been asked to write a book refuting Samuel Hahnemann's ideas. While researching to disprove homeopathy, Hering came across Hahnemann's writings and decided to test the remedies himself. After a personal experience of being cured by homeopathic treatment, he became a convinced supporter of the method. This conversion led him to dedicate his entire life to advancing and systematizing homeopathic medicine.

One of his most famous contributions to homeopathy was his description of the natural process of healing under the right remedy. The 5 directions of cure Dr. Hering observed were:

- **From within outward** - disease leaves vital organs first (like heart, lungs, liver) and appears on less vital surfaces (like skin). For example: an internal chronic complaint improves as a skin eruption appears temporarily.

- **From above downward** - symptoms disappear from the head and upper parts of the body first, then move to lower parts. For example, a patient's headache improves before leg pain resolves.

- **From more important organs to less important ones**

- **In reverse order of appearance of symptoms** - the latest symptoms disappear first, and older symptoms may return temporarily before complete recovery. For example, old eruptions, discharges, or pains may reappear briefly before disappearing entirely.

A Law speaks of a recurrent pattern that exists in Nature. With a thorough conceptual understanding of

these patterns and conditions necessary to fulfill or violate them, one uses the law with hindsight in the various clinical decisions of remedy choice or change, as well as posology. Often this is not a conscious application, but an intuitive guide after achieving adequate conceptual training of the patterns of cure, supported by clinical experience. (2).

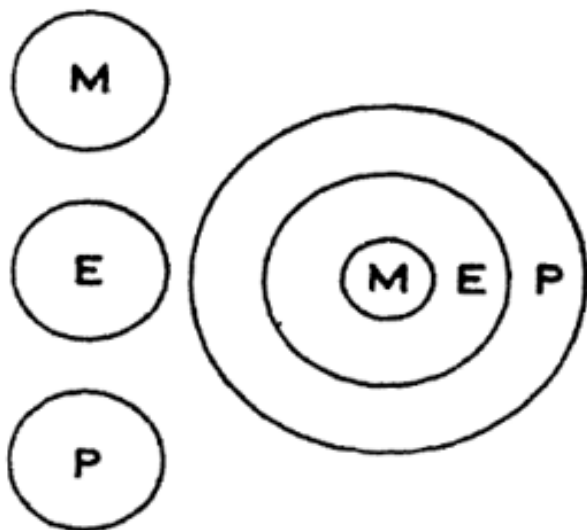
To understand the Law of Direction of Cure, we have to consider three planes the treatment in homeopathy is based on.

There is a readily identifiable hierarchy in the construction of the human being. Most basically, this hierarchy is characterized by three levels:

1. Mental/spiritual
2. Emotional/ Psychic
3. Physical (including sex, sleep, food, and five senses)

These levels are not in reality separate and distinct, but rather there is a complete interaction between them. Nevertheless, the degree of health or disease of the individual can be evaluated from a survey of all three levels. This is a crucial determination for any health practitioner to be able to make, because it is essential for evaluating the progress of the patient.

Of course, there are also hierarchies within these three basic planes. The hierarchies are illustrated in Figure 1.



Within the hierarchy of human functional organization, the **mental plane** occupies the most central and superior position. This level encompasses functions that are fundamental to the expression of individuality and self-awareness — the defining attributes of human

existence. In contrast, the **physical plane**, though vital to sustaining biological life, is considered peripheral in this hierarchy, as it serves primarily as the vehicle through which higher functions manifest (4).

The **mental and spiritual levels** thus represent the most essential domains of human functioning. Broadly defined, the *mental plane* constitutes the sphere of activity responsible for registering and processing changes in **understanding, awareness, and consciousness**. These changes may arise from both internal cognitive processes and external environmental stimuli. It is within this domain that the individual engages in abstract and concrete operations such as **thinking, reasoning, comparing, analyzing, evaluating, creating, visualizing, planning, articulating, and communicating**. Disturbances or impairments in these functions manifest as symptoms of **mental or cognitive pathology** (4).

A **functional hierarchy** also exists within mental processes themselves. Under conditions of comparable intensity, a disturbance of *memory* is considered less severe than an equivalent impairment in *concentration*; a disruption in concentration is less serious than a loss of *discrimination*; and, ultimately, a disturbance in *the capacity to think* represents the most profound level of dysfunction.

An accurate understanding of these gradations is crucial for **prognostic evaluation**. When, during treatment, a patient exhibits a transition from minor to more pronounced cognitive disturbances — for instance, from mild confusion to a significant impairment of coherent thought — this signifies **deterioration in the overall health state**, even if somatic (physical) symptoms appear to improve concurrently.

Immediately subordinate to the mental plane is the **emotional (or affective) plane**, which functions as an essential component of the individual's **adaptive and defensive mechanisms**. This level mediates the **expression and regulation of emotional states**, influencing behavioral responses and the manifestation of affective disorders. It represents the dynamic spectrum of human emotions — such as love and hatred, joy and sadness, serenity and anxiety, courage and fear — each reflecting the organism's internal balance or conflict.

From a qualitative perspective, emotions may be classified as **positive** or **negative** according to their effect on psychological equilibrium. *Positive emotions* promote internal harmony and well-being, whereas *negative emotions* disrupt this equilibrium and predispose the individual to states of distress or psychological instability. Persistent dominance of negative affect — manifesting as apathy, irritability, anxiety, anguish, depression, suicidal ideation, jealousy, hatred, or envy — indicates **pathological imbalance on the emotional plane**.

Assessment of emotional health, therefore, requires evaluating the **extent and persistence of maladaptive emotional states** and their impact on conscious experience, adaptive behavior, and overall psychosomatic integrity.

Understanding the **gradation of symptoms** provides valuable insight into the **direction and quality of a patient's healing process**. The progression of symptoms, when viewed hierarchically across the mental, emotional, and physical planes, reveals whether recovery is proceeding toward restoration of overall balance or toward deeper pathological disturbance.

At the **highest level of emotional health**, the individual attains a state of **dynamic inner equilibrium**, characterized by profound calmness and an integrated sense of love — encompassing self-acceptance, empathy toward others, and harmonious connection with the environment. In contrast, at the **lowest extreme of emotional health**, the individual experiences profound **psychological disintegration**, manifesting as intense anguish or depression so severe that it extinguishes interest in life and may culminate in a conscious or unconscious **desire for death**. Between these two poles exists a broad continuum of emotional states and individualized patterns of affective expression, reflecting varying degrees of psychological balance or disturbance.

The **physical plane**, or the **somatic level of existence**, constitutes the aspect of the human organism that has traditionally been the primary focus of conventional medicine. This domain has been extensively explored through the disciplines of **anatomy, physiology, pathology, biochemistry, and molecular biology**. Yet, despite the vast depth of such investigations, a fundamental principle often remains underrecognized: the **human body, in its structural and functional complexity, operates according to a distinct hierarchy of organ and system importance**.

This hierarchical organization implies that not all organs contribute equally to the maintenance of life or homeostasis. Understanding this principle is essential for interpreting disease progression, evaluating prognosis, and assessing the true direction of healing within the totality of the organism.

When examining the gradation of physiological systems within the human body, the following principles may be employed to elucidate their relative hierarchy:

1. Principle of Functional Centrality: If a particular system contains an organ that plays a central and indispensable role in maintaining overall homeostasis and the sense of well-being, the significance of that system should be ranked according to the criticality of that organ to the organism as a whole.

2. Principle of Functional Impact: The relative im-

portance of an organ can be assessed by evaluating the degree of systemic disturbance resulting from a defined amount of injury to that organ. For instance, a lesion of a given size in the brain will produce a far more profound effect on the organism than an equivalently sized lesion in the heart or in the skin.

The following represents an approximate hierarchical arrangement of body systems and their principal organs, ordered according to their functional importance to the organism:

1. **Nervous system** – encompassing the brain, spinal cord, ganglia and plexuses, and peripheral nerves.
2. **Circulatory system** – including the heart, blood vessels, blood, lymphatic vessels, and lymph.
3. **Endocrine system** – including the pituitary, thyroid and parathyroid glands, adrenal glands, islets of Langerhans, gonads (ovaries and testes), and pineal gland.
4. **Digestive system** – comprising the liver, pancreas, and alimentary canal with its accessory glands.
5. **Respiratory system** – including the lungs, bronchi, trachea, pharynx, and nasal passages.
6. **Excretory (urinary) system** – including the kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra.
7. **Reproductive system** – including the testes, seminal vesicles, penis, urethra, prostate, and bulbourethral glands in males, and the ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, vagina, and vulva in females.
8. **Skeletal system** – consisting of bones, connective tissues, and joints.
9. **Muscular system** – comprising both striated and non-striated (smooth) muscles.

In this classification, the first four systems each contain a **single organ essential to the maintenance of life**—namely, the brain, the heart, the pituitary gland, and the liver. Each of these organs performs a vital, non-redundant function that cannot be compensated for by another organ of similar structure or role.

In contrast, systems lower in the hierarchy (such as the respiratory, excretory, and reproductive systems) contain paired organs—lungs, kidneys, gonads—allowing for a degree of redundancy that supports survival even when one organ is compromised. Further down the hierarchy, the skeletal and muscular systems demonstrate even greater structural multiplicity and functional resilience; for instance, several vertebrae may be damaged without endangering life, and significant portions of muscle tissue may be lost without immediate fatality.

An understanding of this physiological hierarchy provides valuable insight into the **direction of disease progression**. When pathology advances upward within the hierarchy—from systems of lesser to greater vital importance (e.g., from kidneys or lungs toward the

pituitary, heart, and ultimately the brain)—it indicates a **degenerative or adverse progression**. Conversely, when the disease process regresses downward—from higher centers such as the brain toward peripheral structures like the muscles—it reflects a **favorable or curative progression** in the organism's overall health.

Although **Hering's Law of Direction of Cure** does not constitute an empirically verified scientific law (8) in the conventional biomedical sense, it remains a **clinically derived heuristic** that provides a structured framework for evaluating the progression of disease and recovery within homeopathic practice. It reflects the **vitalist philosophy** central to homeopathy — the concept that an intrinsic **vital force** governs the organism's capacity for self-regulation and healing when appropriately stimulated by a similar remedy.

This model emphasizes that **healing is not merely the disappearance of symptoms**, but the **restoration of functional harmony across all levels of human existence** — mental, emotional, and physical. By integrating the hierarchical organization of physiological and psychological functions, Hering's observations contribute to a holistic understanding of health, offering a conceptual bridge between **vitalistic homeopathic philosophy** and **systemic principles of organismic regulation**.

Hering's Law of Direction of Cure provides a conceptual framework for understanding the natural sequence of healing responses within homeopathic therapeutics. While not an empirically validated law in the biomedical sense, it offers a clinically valuable heuristic grounded in the vitalist philosophy of organismic

self-regulation. By emphasizing the hierarchical progression of cure—from the innermost to the outermost, from above downward, and in reverse order of symptom appearance—it serves as a guide for evaluating the quality and direction of recovery. Integrated with Hahnemann's Law of Similars, it defines both the mechanism of therapeutic action and the observable pattern of genuine healing, thereby forming a cornerstone of homeopathic philosophy and clinical methodology.

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